

Module 1

CLAUDE MD

COURSE	AI Workshop 2.0, Desktop Edition
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YOU NEED	A Mac or PC and a paid Claude plan

WHY -- Why This Matters

Every time you start a conversation with Claude Code, it looks for a file called `CLAUDE.md` in your project folder. Without it, you're repeating yourself every session -- "use UK English", "keep it brief", "don't change my files without asking".

With a `CLAUDE.md`, Claude already knows you:

- **Your communication style** -- UK English, concise, no jargon
- **Your preferences** -- what to do when you say certain things
- **Your rules** -- format, structure, what to ask before doing

Before: You repeat yourself every conversation. **After:** Claude reads your rules once and follows them automatically.

WHAT -- What You'll Learn

How to create a CLAUDE.md file that acts as your project's instruction manual for Claude.

```
%%{init: {'theme': 'dark', 'themeVariables': {'nodeTextColor': '#e8e8e8',
'primaryTextColor': '#e8e8e8', 'secondaryTextColor': '#cccccc', 'tertiaryTextColor':
'cccccc', 'clusterBkg': 'transparent', 'clusterBorder': '#8b949e'}}}%%
flowchart LR
    A["Project<br/>folder"] --> B["CLAUDE.md<br/>inside it"]
    B --> C["Claude reads<br/>it automatically"]
    C --> D["Claude follows<br/>your rules"]

    style A fill:none,stroke:#8b949e,stroke-width:1px,color:#c9d1d9
    style B fill:none,stroke:#58a6ff,stroke-width:2px,color:#c9d1d9
    style C fill:none,stroke:#8b949e,stroke-width:1px,color:#c9d1d9
    style D fill:none,stroke:#8b949e,stroke-width:1px,color:#c9d1d9
```

What Goes in Your CLAUDE.md

SECTION	WHAT IT DOES	EXAMPLE
About This Project	Reminds Claude what you're working on	"Amazon product research for kitchen niche"
Communication Style	How Claude should talk to you	"UK English, brief, no waffle"
Intent Mapping	"When I say X, you do Y"	"find the report" -> Claude searches your files
Format Rules	How output should look	"Tables for data, short paragraphs, TL;DR first"
My Preferences	Rules you want Claude to follow	"Always ask before changing spreadsheets"

Example: Amazon Seller's CLAUDE.md

This file tells Claude how to work on this project.

About This Project

Project: Amazon Kitchen Niche Research **Main Goal:** Find profitable products and create listings

How Claude Should Communicate

- Use UK English spelling (colour, organise, catalogue)
- Keep responses brief and actionable
- No marketing fluff -- just the facts
- When analysing data, show me the numbers first

Intent Mapping

I SAY	YOU DO
"find [something]"	Search the project for matching files
"summarise this"	Key points first, skip the waffle
"check the numbers"	Open the spreadsheet, show a summary table

Format Rules

- Tables for data under 10 rows
- Short paragraphs (3-4 lines max)
- Always include search volume when suggesting keywords

My Preferences

- Don't change my spreadsheets without asking
- When writing listings, focus on benefits not features



HOW -- The Self-Drive Process

Where does CLAUDE.md go?

Your CLAUDE.md file goes **inside your project folder** -- the same folder you open in your terminal. For example: `~/my-amazon-project/CLAUDE.md`

NOT in `~/.claude/` -- that's a different system folder. If you put it there, Claude won't find it when you're working on your project.

Quick check: your CLAUDE.md should be in the **same folder** as your other project files.

1. **You read** this README (done)
2. **You give Claude the self-drive file** -- open `CLAUDE-MD-SELF-DRIVE.md`, copy the contents, paste into Claude Code
3. **Claude asks you 3 questions** -- what's your project, what do you need help with, how should Claude communicate
4. **Claude creates your CLAUDE.md** -- tailored to your answers

Tips

- **Start simple** -- you can always add more rules later
- **Add as you go** -- when Claude does something you don't like, add a rule
- **Be specific** -- "UK English" is better than "write properly"
- **Test it** -- start a new conversation and see if Claude follows your rules

Common Questions

QUESTION	ANSWER
Where does the file go?	In your project folder -- the folder you open in Claude Code
Different files per project?	Yes. Each project folder can have its own CLAUDE.md
How do I update it?	Edit the file directly, or ask Claude to add something
Can I see what's in it?	Ask Claude "What are my preferences?"

There's also a test folder (`TEST-CLAUDE-MD/`) with a sample CLAUDE.md you can look at.

WHAT IF -- What This Unlocks

Your CLAUDE.md is the foundation everything else builds on. From here:

- **Module 2** -- Add a Master Log so Claude remembers what you worked on across sessions (session memory)
- **Module 3** -- Create slash commands, skills, and use Plan Mode (speed and control)
- **Module 4** -- Connect Claude to external services with MCPs (calendars, browsers, files)

The CLAUDE.md stays with your project forever. Every new feature you add in later modules builds on top of it.

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